



GOLDEN RULES

MBDA



1. SAFETY IS NOT OPTIONAL

All flight operations, tests, and demonstrations must prioritize safety.

Teams are responsible for ensuring that their systems are operated in a controlled, responsible, and compliant manner at all times.

2. COMPETE HARD, BUT PLAY FAIR

This is a competition, but fairness, respect, and professional conduct are non-negotiable. Technical ambition should never come at the expense of safety, integrity, or mutual respect.

3. COLLABORATION BEATS COMPETITION

While the format is competitive, the overarching goal is cooperation, exchange, and international networking.

Supporting other teams, sharing insights, and learning together are considered strengths, not weaknesses.

4. BEING PROFESSIONAL IS PART OF THE CHALLENGE

Technical excellence matters, but so does reliability, clarity in communication, and respectful behavior.

Teams are expected to

- act professionally toward organizers, partners, jury members, and fellow participants.
- respect schedules, time slots, and deadlines defined by the organizers.
- remain flexible and solution-oriented, necessary due to unforeseen external circumstances.

5. TRANSPARENCY IS KEY

If something is unclear, please ask. If something feels inconsistent, raise it. If you do not understand why, please feel free to share your doubts.

Many misunderstandings arise from assumptions rather than intent. Open communication is always preferred over silent frustration.

6. COMMUNICATE EARLY

Plans change. Travel issues occur. Schedules shift. If anything does not work out as planned, teams are expected to inform the organizing team as early as possible.

A short, proactive message helps everyone manage the situation fairly and efficiently.

7. ONE TEAM, ONE VOICE

Each team should designate a clear primary contact person for organizational communication to avoid confusion, delays, or conflicting messages.

8. BUY TO BUILD

The material grant is intended to support the development and demonstration of your challenge-related technology.

Components such as rotors, sensors, electronics, control units, software, or test equipment are considered eligible if they are clearly required for the challenge setup. General-purpose or personal equipment is not.

Guiding principle: if it directly contributes to building, controlling, or testing your system, it belongs here.

9. TRAVEL SUPPORT IS JUST SUPPORT

The travel grant is a contribution toward expenses, not a guarantee of full coverage.

If total costs exceed the grant, the remaining amount must be covered by the participating team. Participation in the challenge implies accepting this shared investment, balanced by the opportunity to compete for a significant prize pool.

10. PASS ON IF POSSIBLE

Teams that do not require the full material travel grant, or do not require a grant at all, are kindly asked to inform the organizing team. This may allow us to reallocate limited resources to teams with greater need.

Please note: redistribution is not guaranteed, but transparency is highly appreciated.

11. YOUR IP STAYS YOURS

All intellectual property remains with the respective teams and participants. This applies equally toward organizers, partners, jury members, and other teams.

All participants are expected to respect this principle in their actions, discussions, and external communication.

12. JURY DECISIONS

The jury evaluates based on the criteria communicated in advance. Questions for clarification are welcome, but jury decisions are not subject to negotiation.

13. REPRESENT THE CHALLENGE RESPONSIBLY

Public statements, social media posts, and press communication related to the challenge should be factual, respectful, and aligned with the collaborative and professional spirit of the event.

FINAL NOTE

The Swarm Drone Challenge is designed high-trust, high-intensity environment. We provide a platform, resources, and vi

In return, we expect responsibility, open and a collaborative competitive spirit.

When these principles are shared, the challenge becomes more than a cont it becomes a collective achievement.

Your SDC Crew